

JOINING THE COMPANY WAS THE MOST LOGICAL THING, BUT MY FATHER NEVER FORCED ME"

JYOTHY M.R.
MANAGING DIRECTOR, JYOTHY LABS

- **Responsible for driving product innovation, including strengthening key brands in fabric care, dishwashing and personal care segments**
- **Grown revenues from ₹1,711 crore in FY20 to ₹2,944 crore in FY26, Profit after tax from grew from ₹162.6 crore to ₹333.2 crore over the same period**
- **Hit upon the idea to create a kit with a scrubber, a product that went on to revolutionise the segment**

trust, making decisions when they need to be made and taking responsibility for those decisions. When people know that you value their experience and are genuinely willing to listen, I believe it becomes much easier to work together," she says.

Jyothy M.R. recalls how she spent hours at business meetings after joining Jyothy Labs in 2005 with no specific designation or responsibility. Now Managing Director of a company named after her, she was clear about wanting to join the business from the time she was a teenager. "It was the most logical thing for me, but my father never forced me; he left it to me to decide," she says.

Sometimes, a small idea can prove career defining and help cement one's place in the organisation. For Jyothy, the breakthrough came in 2009 when the company wanted to boost its market share in Southern India and a senior executive asked her to step up. "I washed dishes at home and knew it was a messy job," she says. That's how she hit upon the idea to create a kit with a scrubber, a product that went on to revolutionise the segment. "Exo made me, how Ujala made my dad," she says candidly. This gave her, and perhaps her father, the confidence to let her get involved with the other brands in the portfolio as well, leading up to her being appointed Managing Director in 2020.

For Lupin's Gupta, being given charge of the US market ended up becoming a career defining experience. "At the time, the opportunity was far from obvious. We were entering a landscape dominated by large, established players, and convincing internal stakeholders to back a bold, resource-intensive US expansion required presenting a clear, long-term strategic vision," she says. "One of the most important lessons I have learned is that trust cannot be demanded; it is earned over time through judgement,